



SOURCES PANEL

 **What you can do here:** Upload your research documents (PDFs, Word docs, RTF, TXT, MD) or XLSX with a statements tab, and organize them with custom metadata like participant demographics or interview dates by adding and editing **custom columns**. This is your document library and metadata manager.

Upload & Setup

Upload Source Texts

- **New Project or Upload Sources** (green + in the Projects bar): besides files, you can **paste plain text** into **Or paste text**; it is imported like a TXT file as `pasted-text.txt`. You can combine paste with file picks in one step.
- **Click to select** one or more PDFs, DOCX, RTF, TXT, MD, or XLSX files
- **XLSX**: Requires a `statements` tab with `source_id` and `text` columns; other columns become custom columns. Optional `sources` tab for metadata. Adds sources to the current project (no new project created).
- **Optionally split large documents into multiple sources** using separator patterns
- **Optionally set custom columns on upload** (applies to all uploaded sources)
- Type an existing column name (or a new one) and optionally set a fixed value, e.g. `Country = Zambia`
- Leave the value blank to just add the column (no value set during upload)
- **Confirm Upload modal** (shown when "Show Advanced" is on in **New Project or Upload Sources**) lets you adjust filenames→ID mapping, add custom columns, and split sources. When Show Advanced is off (default), uploads use defaults (keep filenames as IDs, no custom columns, no split) and skip this screen.
- On completion, the app automatically:
 - selects the sources via **Sources Dropdown**
 - switches to the **Create Links** sub-tab and loads the first source's text into it
 - on the right, switches to Sources panel with and the View & Edit subpanel

Splitting documents into multiple sources with source separators

This feature helps you split individual documents you upload into multiple sources. These separators are *hard*: you use them just once, on uploading one or more documents, to produce multiple sources.

- In the Confirm Upload screen, there is a Sources Separator text box
- Text lines matching special "regex" patterns separate into multiple sources. So if you have sections marked with "Source Number 12", "Source Number 13" etc, just put "Source Number.*" in the box.
- This will produce multiple sources with "Source Number 12" etc as `source_id`

- Live preview of new source IDs with count
- User can leave blank for normal upload

Section Separators

This feature helps you split existing source texts into sections. These separators are *soft*: they don't permanently change the file and you can add or remove one or more separators on the fly.

- Into the box, type one **regex pattern per line**. The pattern must match the *whole separator line* in your source text, so use `.*` to match the rest of the line. For example, if your text contains lines like `statement_id: 42` or `Question 7: ...`, enter `statement_id:.*` or `Question.*` respectively.
- Matching lines are styled as **headings** in the text viewer.
- Each link is assigned to the section it falls under. The matched text (e.g. `statement_id: 42`) becomes the section value, available as a column (e.g. `section_statement_id`) in:
- The [Everything Filter](#) — so you can show only links from specific sections
- The [Sections Filter](#)
- Pivot tables and statistics
- Links before the first separator in a source get the value `Initial Text`.

Sample Check

You want a table showing your sample: gender * region?

Use this simple customisable table to check your sample according to any [custom columns](#) you have defined.

- See also: [Pivot Tables](#) and [Analysis Filters](#).

Custom Column Analysis

- **Aggregate by** multi-select for cross-tabulation
- **1 column**: Simple count table
- **2 columns**: Cross-tabulation table
- **Maximum 10 values** per column for analysis
- **URL state preserved** for bookmarking

View & Edit Your Sources

- See also: [Tips for all tables](#) and [Custom columns](#).

Sources Table

- NEW column **Source Prompt** - this new column shows the first few characters of any text in this field. It can be edited as usual with the existing pencil icon/ edit button in each row.

- **Edit the source text:** the pencil/edit button opens the Edit Source modal, where the **Content** field is now editable along with the title, source prompt and custom fields. Changing the existing text will probably break any links coded beyond the point of the change, because each link remembers where in the text it was coded and those positions shift. Where possible, only add new text at the end. Saving after a text change asks you to confirm first.
- **Checkbox selection** for analysis pipeline
- **Row editing** with keyboard navigation
- **Custom columns** for metadata
- **Column visibility control:**
 - Click the small **:** in any header to hide that column (or hide selected columns) and quickly show hidden columns again.
- **Manage Columns**  is the main source-table column manager. It includes a checkbox list for Sources table columns, with **Select all** / **Select none** / **All source** / **No source**, and drag-to-reorder.
- **Uncoded column** - Shows true/false for sources with no links; filterable to find uncoded sources
- **Fullscreen mode** available

Table Editing Features

- **Range selection** - Click and drag
- **Copy/paste** - Ctrl+C, Ctrl+V
- **Arrow key navigation**
- **Delete/Backspace** to clear cells
- **Column/row selection** - Click headers
- **Double-click editing**

Custom Columns

Custom columns are where you store extra data about each of your sources, e.g. gender, location, type; whatever you want. You can create, edit and remove custom columns. Then you can use them to filter your data.

- You can also use them for source-level memo columns; see [Link custom columns](#) for the same idea on individual causal links.
- **Manage Columns**  opens a modal to add/remove custom columns, choose which Sources table columns are visible, and reorder them
- After you add a custom column and reopen the modal, the new column appears as an existing project column; the add box starts empty again
- Column **names** are tidied automatically when you create or rename them: only letters, numbers, spaces, hyphens and underscores are kept, so other symbols (such as **\$** or **/**) are dropped. This stops odd characters from breaking the column.
- **Double-click a cell in a custom column to edit it** or via source edit modal
- **Copy and paste** selections with ctrl-C, ctrl-V.

- **These columns are available elsewhere in the app, e.g.**
- In the [Source Groups filter](#)
- In the [Everything filter](#)
- In the [Sample Check table](#)
- Link custom columns work the same way in the [Links Table](#), but apply to individual causal links rather than sources.